MIL-H-37236A
26 June 1989
SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-37236
5 March 1976

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE (Hegar-Mayo)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers three sizes of Hegar-Mayo suture needle holders.

1.2 Classification. Holders shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Sizes	Length (in inches)
1,3	6
2,4	7
5	10

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation. (See 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-RST, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal, (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding Paperboard-Less than 20 pounds
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Locked-covered.
PPP-B-636	- Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Set-up.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	- Liner Case and Sheet, Overwrap, Water Vaporproof Or Flexible.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147	- Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-794	- Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging of.

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099).

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

No. 2228	Holder, Suture Needle, Hegar-Mayo, 6 Inch
No. 2229	Holder, Suture Needle, Hegar-Mayo, 7 Inch
No. 20118	Holders, Suture Needle, Hegar-Mayo

(Copies of other Government documents, drawings and publications are available from Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-RST, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of documents cited in the solicitation (See 6.2).

ASTM

ASTM E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials, Test for.

ASTM E 92 - Vickers Hardness of Metallic Materials, Tests for.

ASTM E 140 - Hardness Conversion Tables for Metals (Relationship Between Brinell Hardness, Vickers Hardness, Rockwell Hardness, Rockwell Superficial Hardness and Knoop Hardness).

ASTM F 899 - Stainless Steel Billet, Bar and Wire for Surgical Instruments.

ASTM F 921 - Standard Definition of Terms Relating to Hemostatic Forceps.

ASTM F 1026- General Workmanship and Performance Measurement of Hemostatic Forceps.

ASTM F 1089- Standard Test Method for Corrosion of Surgical Instruments.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA. 19103-1187).

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The holder shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements specified herein. The terms used to describe the components and portions of the holder described in this specification shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation F921.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Holder proper. The holder shall be fabricated from Class 4, martensitic corrosion-resistant steel, in accordance with ASTM Designation F899.

3.2.2 Jaw inserts (or material plated on inside of jaws). The jaw inserts, or plating on inside of jaws, shall be straight tungsten carbide (Class 9). Teeth shall have their crests well defined and uniform throughout the jaws. Serrated inserts shall be joined to the jaws with a uniform flow of silver solder and be free of crevices at all interfaces. Plated jaws shall have a thickness of 0.004 ± 0.001 inch, inclusive of crests. Teeth shall be well defined and crested.

3.3 Hardness. The hardness of the holder proper shall be Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) 40 to 45. The tungsten carbide jaws (insert or flame plating) shall have a Rockwell Hardness A scale (HRA) of 80, minimum. The hardness shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1.

3.4 Style, design and dimensions. The holder shall be a suture needle holder of the Hegar-Mayo design. Sizes 1 and 2 shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center Drawing Numbers 2228 and 2229 respectively. Sizes 3 and 4 with central slotted grooves and size 5 shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing Number 20118.

3.5 Locks. The holder shall be of the box lock type in accordance with ASTM Designation F1026.

3.6 Finish. Holders, except jaw inserts, or jaw plating, shall have a mirror, satin or matte (glare resistant) finish. For the mirror finish, the locks and ratchets shall be polished smooth but need not possess a mirror finish. Should the holder possess a matte finish, it shall exhibit a uniform, non-directional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure. The instrument shall be properly passivated.

3.7 Instrument closure. When closing the instrument, the jaws shall first close and then progressively tighten with each ratchet position. Each ratchet position shall hold firmly and release instantly. The serrations shall be consistent in depth and shall mesh completely and properly during closure.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.8 Resistance to corrosion. The suture needle holder shall show no evidence of corrosion when tested in accordance with 4.5.2.

3.9 Needle retention. Needle retention shall be tested as specified in 4.5.3.

3.10 Identification marking. The holder shall bear the contractor's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Holders of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

3.11 Workmanship. Holders shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, auditory, etc. investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.2.2 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the steel may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one holder.

TABLE I. Sampling criteria for examination.

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

4.3.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one holder. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective
Hardness	3.3	4.5.1	S-2	1.5
Dimensions	3.4	-----	S-2	4.0
Box-lock test	3.5	ASTM F1026	S-2	2.5
Corrosion-resistance test	3.8	4.5.2	S-2	1.0
Needle retention test	3.9	4.5.3	S-2	1.0

4.3.3 Raw materials. Sufficient quantity of each lot of material used in the construction of the suture needle holders shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.4 Examination.

4.4.1 Examination of holder. The holder shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any holder in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective items in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for test sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Style and design not as specified.
102	Holders not free of cracks, pits, dents, nicks, sharp edges, grind marks and burrs.
103	Serrations not as specified, complete or well defined.
104	Ratchet teeth not uniform.
105	Ratchet teeth do not function properly.
106	Holders not free from excessive play in box-lock area.
Minor	
201	Finish not uniform.
202	Indentification marking not present, correct, complete or legible.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Hardness test. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 or E92. Conversion of Vickers hardness values to Rockwell values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E140.

4.5.2 Corrosion resistance test. Corrosion resistance of the suture needle holder shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

4.5.3 Needle retention test. The longitudinal axis of a 0.015 inch diameter suture needle shall be held perpendicular to the axis of the jaws, centrally located in the jaws, with the third position of the ratchet engaged. With the ratchet engaged in the third position and the jaws clamped on the needle, the needle shall display no lateral, rotational or longitudinal movement when attempted by hand. Upon disengagement of the ratchets and removal of the needle, there shall be no visible distortion of the instrument jaws.

4.5.4 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

4.6 Inspection of packaging. The inspection of the preservation-packaging and interior package marking shall be in accordance with the group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning and drying. Suture holders shall be cleaned and dried in accordance with MIL-P-116.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1.2 Preservative applications. Preservatives shall not be used.

5.1.1.3 Unit package. One suture holder of the size specified shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1.

5.1.1.4 Intermediate package. Twelve unit packages containing suture needle holders of one size only shall be packaged in a snug fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level C.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Preservation for suture holders of the size specified shall conform to the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate package. Twelve suture holders of one size only shall be packaged in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A,B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twenty-four intermediate packages containing suture holders of one size only shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-621, class 2, or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall be as specified in the liner specification. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four intermediate packages containing suture holders of one size only shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, domestic type, PPP-B-621, class 1, or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Twenty-four intermediate packages containing suture holders of one size only shall be packed in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.2.5 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be used whenever total quantities for shipment to one destination exceed 250 pounds or 20 cubic feet. Loads shall be unitized on pallets conforming to MIL-STD-147. Quantities less than 20 cubic feet need not be unitized. Pallet loads including the pallet shall not exceed 54 inches in height, 52 inches in width, and 43 inches in length. Pallet shall conform to Type IV or Type V.

5.2.5.1 Levels A and B. Suture holders of one size only packed as specified in 5.2.1 and 5.2.2 shall be unitized on pallets as specified in 5.2.5.

5.2.5.2 Level C. Suture holders of one size only packed as specified in 5.2.3. shall be unitized as specified in MIL-STD-794.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Level A, B and C. Each unit pack, intermediate package, exterior container and unitized load shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

5.4 General.

5.4.1 Exterior container. Exterior container (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, and 5.2.3) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.6.

6. NOTES
(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. These suture needle holders of Hegar-Mayo design are to be used for grasping suture needles during surgery.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of the specification.
b. Classification (see 1.2).
c. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1. and 2.1.2).
d. Levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Applicable National Stock Numbers.

6.3 National Stock Number coverage. This specification covers the following National Stock Numbers (NSNs).

National Stock No.	Size	Item Identification
6515-00-299-8736	1	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Hegar-Mayo, 6 Inch
6515-00-299-8737	2	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Hegar-Mayo, 7 Inch
6515-00-341-9100	3	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Hegar-Mayo, Jaws W/Central Slotted Grooves, 6 Inch
6515-00-341-9200	4	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Hegar-Mayo, Jaws W/Central Slotted Grooves, 7 Inch
6515-01-164-8884	5	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Hegar-Mayo, 10 Inch

6.4 Subject (keyword) listing:

Grasper
Gripper
Holding instrument

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FHA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-3702

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-H-37236A	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE (Hegar-Mayo)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

EFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

)FFICIAL BUSINESS
ENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.